



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Caprock Academy

School Website: <https://caprockacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL****Classicality Audit: Candeo Schools (candeoschools.com)****Executive Summary**

- Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Why: Candeo Schools explicitly centers its mission on “growing wisdom and virtue” and the pursuit of “truth, goodness, and beauty,” aligns its curriculum with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), teaches Latin (4–8), and references “recitation,” “wonder,” and “Western Civilization.” It integrates Core Knowledge with Hillsdale’s K–12 “classical and American” curriculum. However, the site provides no evidence of theological grounding or liturgical life, and only partial evidence of the distinctively classical pedagogies (Socratic seminars, chanting/singing, restful scholé) and faculty/parent formation expected in the tradition. These gaps keep the school from a fully CLASSICAL designation.
- Website used: <https://candeoschools.com/>

**CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS**

Required criteria include: transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, and liturgical/communal practices (per the Six Elements framework). Positive and negative indicator lexicon used from the “Six Essential Elements” document and lexicon.

**1) Keyword evidence found on the school site**

- Positive terms present: “truth,” “good,” “beautiful/beauty,” “virtue,” “wisdom,” “wonder,” “moral formation/character” (Candeo About/Mission/Philosophy; Handbook; Curriculum pages)
- Additional positive framing via Hillsdale affiliation: “liberal arts and sciences,” “civic virtue,” “moral character” (Hillsdale curriculum section)
- Terms not found: theology, liturgy, worship, chapel, catechesis
- No negative terms detected: values□neutral, moral relativism, subjective truth

**2) Comparison to Positive/Negative Indicators (Six Elements)**

- Positive: transcendental language (truth/goodness/beauty), virtue/wisdom (strong alignment)
- Missing: grounded in theology; liturgical practices (no evidence)

**3) Quantitative keyword counts**

- Positive hits: 7 (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, wonder, moral formation)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive = 100% ( $7/(7+0)$ ); Coverage of sub□criteria  $\approx 0.33$  (meets 1/3: moral realism affirmed; theology and liturgy absent)

**4) Category score**

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

## CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Criteria: virtue/wisdom as telos; formation (not mere information); reality of truth, goodness, beauty.

### 1) Keyword evidence

- “We cultivate wisdom and virtue... forming hearts and minds... pursue what is true, love what is good, and delight in what is beautiful” (About page)
- “Education... is a formative journey... classrooms are places of order and wonder” (About)
- “Grow wisdom and virtue for a life well lived” (Mission/Welcome/Handbook)

### 2) Indicator comparison

- Strong alignment with formation and the transcendentals; rejection of mere job□prep emphasis implicit (no “college & career ready” framing)

### 3) Quantitative

- Positive hits: 8 (wisdom, virtue, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, wonder, telos/life well lived)
- Negative: 0
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage ≈ 1.00 (all three sub□criteria clearly affirmed)

### 4) Category score

- CLASSICAL
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## CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Criteria: Trivium; history (not social studies); Great Books/Great Conversation; cultivation of wonder.

### 1) Keyword evidence

- Trivium named and defined (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) (Curriculum & Instruction)
- Latin (Grades 4–8) (Handbook Academics)
- History and Geography, Western Civilization (not framed as “social studies”)
- “Classic Literature,” “Western civilization’s greatest works,” “wonder” (Handbook + Elementary/Middle School pages)
- Integrates Hillsdale “classical and American” curriculum with Core Knowledge content framework (clear articulation; content□specific sequence)

### 2) Indicator comparison

- Positive: explicit Trivium, classical languages, Great Works/Western Civ, wonder orientation.
- No explicit negatives (e.g., “project□based learning dominance,” “social studies replaces history”) detected.

### 3) Quantitative

- Positive hits: 10 (Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Great Works, Western Civilization, history, wonder, classical literature)
- Negative: 0
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage ≈ 1.00 (all four sub□criteria represented)

### 4) Category score

- CLASSICAL
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## CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

Criteria: restful scholé; grammar□stage chanting/singing/recitation; logic□stage Socratic/seminars/debates; rhetoric□stage speeches/orations. K–8 schools can be classical without high□school Socratic seminars, but lower□school memory/recitation should be evident.

### 1) Keyword evidence

- Lower school: “recitation, music” emphasized (K–3); memory & delight cues (Handbook)
- Middle school: “formal logic, rhetoric” (Handbook)
- “Wonder” and “joyful learning” referenced repeatedly (About/Philosophy/Curriculum)
- Not found on site: explicit “Socratic seminar,” “debate,” “orations/thesis,” “scholé,” “chanting/singing” (singing/chanting not asserted, though “music” and “recitation” are)

### 2) Indicator comparison

- Positive: recitation is present (lower school), logic/rhetoric named (upper levels)
- Missing/weak: explicit Socratic seminars/debates; restful scholé; chanting/singing; rhetoric orations. Note: K–8 range mitigates the lack of high□school rhetoric orations.

### 3) Quantitative

- Positive hits: 3 (recitation, logic, rhetoric)
- Negative hits: 0 (no project□based/experiential□only emphasis found)
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage ≈ 0.50 (meets ~2 of 4 pedagogical emphases: memory/recitation and logic/rhetoric; scholé and explicitly Socratic/seminar evidence not present)

### 4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
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## CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Criteria: teachers as models/mentors; collegial culture; portrait of a teacher/student.

### 1) Keyword evidence

- “Teachers model and teach appropriate conduct... integrity, attentiveness, responsibility” (Handbook)
- “Faculty who care deeply and lead with purpose”; leaders “cultivate an environment of intellectual and moral virtue” (About/Home)

### 2) Indicator comparison

- Positive: moral exemplarity/virtue language applied to teachers; evidence of leadership cultivating virtue.
- Missing: explicit “portrait of a teacher/student,” faculty formation in classical pedagogy, “faculty of friends” language.

### 3) Quantitative

- Positive hits: 2 (teachers model virtue; leaders cultivate virtue)
- Negative: 0
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage ≈ 0.50 (≈ half of the ideal faculty signals evident)

### 4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
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## CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Criteria: partnering with parents as co-educators; parent formation opportunities; open/hospitable campus.

### 1) Keyword evidence

- “Partnership with Families” named as a core value; “walking alongside parents” (About)
- Parent resources (handbook, calendar, tours, contact) readily visible; mutual alignment emphasized (handbook acknowledgement)
- Not found: explicit parent formation (book clubs/seminars), open-campus hospitality language.

### 2) Indicator comparison

- Positive: partnership emphasis clearly stated.
- Missing: routine parent education in classical philosophy; explicit “parents welcome anytime” statements.

### 3) Quantitative

- Positive hits: 2 (parent partnership, tours/engagement mechanisms)
- Negative: 0
- Percent positive: 100%; Coverage  $\approx 0.50$  ( $\approx$  half of the desired parent/community signals evident)

### 4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

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## Aggregate Rating

- Religious & Metaphysical: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

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## What would move the needle (to CLASSICAL)

- Add explicit theological grounding and liturgical life (if appropriate to the school’s governance model), or at minimum, a principled statement of metaphysics that grounds the transcendentals beyond civic virtue; integrate chapel, morning prayer, hymnody, or a coherent sacred aesthetic if faith-based (or a clear metaphysical posture if not) to fully satisfy Element 1.
  - Make pedagogy explicit: publish descriptions of Socratic seminars (upper grades), formal debates, orations/capstones, and restful scholē practices; in lower school, name chanting/singing and routine recitation techniques.
  - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate,” and describe faculty formation in classical pedagogy (“teacher as mentor,” “living curriculum”).
  - Offer parent formation: classical education reading groups, seminars, or workshops so parents can share the school’s classical philosophy, not only policies.
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**Evidence Appendix (selected)**

- Mission/Philosophy and partnership language: “grow wisdom and virtue,” “true, good, beautiful,” “partnership with families” (About; Mission; Core Values).
- Curriculum: Trivium, Latin (4–8), Western Civilization, Classic Literature, recitation/music (K–3), logic/rhetoric (7–8).
- Wonder emphasized (Elementary/Middle School pages).
- Hillsdale “classical and American” curriculum; civic virtue/moral character.

Note on keyword framework: Positive/negative indicators and category criteria referenced from Six Essential Elements and the classicality lexicon.

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## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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